



From ₹2 million to ₹250 billion

Donning a cap with multiple feathers—operations, systems design, sales and CEO-MD—Mohan was ready to unfurl his wings and let his dreams take flight. While he advocates for developing a sense of ownership for one's work, the feeling of building something of his own and working to raise it to touch the skies did not leave him. "I had spent 18 years working for others, always feeling like I was working for myself. I have no regrets; that is how life went by," he declares.

Rome wasn't built in a day, nor was Cyient (InfoTech Enterprises Limited then). With just 2 million rupees in his pocket, a dream, and the will to make a mark, Mohan embarked on a journey to build a design engineering services company that would one day employ more than 18,000 people and be valued around ₹250 billion. In 2014, with the thesis—"what we design can lead us to manufacturing (DLM)" the company added electronics manufacturing capabilities by acquiring Rangsons Electronics. Today, the electronics manufacturing business is an independent company (CYIENT DLM) and is listed on NSE/BSE. CYIENT DLM has electronics manufacturing facilities in Mysore and Hyderabad and mechanical components manufacturing in Bangalore. He attributes this success to the support of his wife, Sucharitha.

"My wife initially had reservations about my plans, but once convinced, she became my strongest supporter throughout this journey. She took care of our family—looking after our two children. My son Krishna (then 14) and daughter Vaishnavi (then 10) were in their formative years when I embarked on this new path at 40. She managed the household, allowing me to pursue my ambitions. Sometimes, it amazes me



Striving for excellence in education for all

to reflect on all those years when I spent over 100 nights away from home, constantly travelling to acquire customers," he ponders.

Mohan marvels at how Sucharitha encouraged him to focus on growing the business without letting him worry about their children. "She was a director on the company board but always managed to balance family and work. Reflecting on it now, I wish I could have spent some more time with my kids, especially seeing how well they are doing with their own children today, but some compromises had to be made for a better future," he reflects.

"We worked tirelessly and methodically to build our company from the ground up while ensuring that we still instil our children with the same values that we prided ourselves over—hard work, integrity, and sincerity," says Mohan.

The couple prioritised financial security and the division of responsibilities between themselves. "As

the MD-CEO of OMC Computers, I had two cars with drivers at home. However, as a startup, we couldn't afford such luxuries. My wife and I decided to outline our needs and cut down on all unnecessary expenditures. It was quite challenging in the beginning," he recalls.

Together, the couple decided to invest in a commercial property using their savings and an old property they owned. As a fun fact, Mohan reveals the name of the first lessee of their commercial property. "I leased the property to TCS (Tata Consultancy Services) for a long-term contract!" he smiles.

Trudging tirelessly through triumphs and troughs

Mohan reveals that Azim Premji offered him to join Wipro. "He said that I embody the values of a middle-class Tamil Brahmin—'God-fearing and diligent.' Despite his offer, I was driven by my own ambitions and chose to remain an en-